



MENTAL MODELS · 01

The Map Is Not The Territory

A framework for reading AI output without over-trusting it.



Every AI model is a map. Not
the territory.



A language model's confidence has
nothing to do with its accuracy.



It describes a wrong answer with the same fluency as a right one — because it's not reasoning about truth, it's predicting plausible text.



The moment you treat AI output as ‘the map’ instead of ‘the truth,’ you ask better questions:



ASK YOURSELF

- 1 What did this leave out?
- 2 What would change if the input changed?
- 3 Where would this map mislead me?



**One of the core mental models we
teach at Verlin Labs.**

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